SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

6 August 2021 · Shift 1

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To add insult to injury

(A) to make fun of someone
(B) to work hard on making up
(C) to make something worse
(D) to wound physically

Q.2

Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. Then he started on his eighteen kilometer expedition back to his village. B. Mohan first equipped himself with a long, sturdy stick. C. At several points, he lost the road and had to swim his way ahead. D. It was a journey he would never forget where he had to use his stick constantly to locate the road.

(A) DCAB
(B) ACBD
(C) CDBA
(D) BADC

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. He is very impulsive and does things “without rhyme or reason”.

(A) without proper planning
(B) without a reasonable explanation
(C) without any resources
(D) without anyone’s help

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. LAVISH

(A) excessive
(B) luxurious
(C) tiny
(D) frugal

Q.5

Examine the four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Next, keep tapping the pot on all sides and at the bottom until the plant loosens. B. Finally, slide the plant gently and remove the old potting mix on a newspaper. C. The first thing to do when repotting is to remove the plant from the current pot. D. Begin by holding the plant gently, and turning the pot sideways.

(A) CDAB
(B) DBCA
(C) BDAC
(D) ACDB

Q.6

Fill in the blank with most appropriate word. This part of the sea _____ with sharks.

(A) expands
(B) crowds
(C) suffices
(D) teems

Q.7

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. AFFINITY

(A) aversion
(B) weakness
(C) inclination
(D) attraction

Q.8

Select the misspelt word.

(A) applause
(B) modern
(C) arrivel
(D) serious

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. LIVID

(A) furious
(B) timid
(C) mild
(D) lively

Q.10

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. He drove the car very carefully on the hilly terrain.

(A) The car was driven very carefully on the hilly terrain.
(B) The car is being driven very carefully on the hilly terrain.
(C) The car has been driven very carefully on the hilly terrain.
(D) The car is driven very carefully on the hilly terrain.

Q.11

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. If you rent a house near your office, it will save you time as well as also money.

(A) If you rent a house
(B) as well as also money
(C) near your office
(D) it will save you time

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. Small desert animals burrow underground "across the days" and come out only at night.

(A) within the days
(B) during the day
(C) No substitution
(D) between days

Q.13

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. "I love Bollywood music," Deepu said to Reena.

(A) Deepu told Reena that he loved Bollywood music.
(B) Deepu will say to Reena that he loved Bollywood music.
(C) Deepu says to Reena that he loves Bollywood music.
(D) Deepu had told Reena that he loved Bollywood music.

Q.14

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Killing of one's mother

(A) infanticide
(B) patricide
(C) regicide
(D) matricide

Q.15

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Notwithstanding we were / all busy that weekend / we had to / cancel the outing.

(A) cancel the outing
(B) we had to
(C) Notwithstanding we were
(D) all busy that weekend

Q.16

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) aggravate
(B) titilate
(C) mediate
(D) initiate

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. CALLOUS

(A) inaccurate
(B) insensitive
(C) incredible
(D) inexperienced

Q.18

Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words. a period of two weeks

(A) month
(B) century
(C) decade
(D) fortnight

Q.19

Select the option that will improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement' I must have dropped “one” of my gloves in the car.

(A) any
(B) No improvement
(C) an
(D) the

Q.20

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. It is _____ to see so many of our fellow Indians help the migrants in their struggle to go home.

(A) savouring
(B) heartening
(C) reuniting
(D) relishing

Q.21

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. In the ‘Kingdom of Fools’, both the king and the ministers were complete fools. They didn’t want to do things (1)_____ other kingdoms, so they decided to (2)_____ night into day and day into night. They (3)_____ that everyone should be awake at night, (4)_____ their lands and run their (5)_____ only after dark and should go to bed as soon as the sun came up.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(A) like
(B) than
(C) so as
(D) same

Q.22

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. In the ‘Kingdom of Fools’, both the king and the ministers were complete fools. They didn’t want to do things (1)_____ other kingdoms, so they decided to (2)_____ night into day and day into night. They (3)_____ that everyone should be awake at night, (4)_____ their lands and run their (5)_____ only after dark and should go to bed as soon as the sun came up.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(A) adjust
(B) develop
(C) change
(D) agree

Q.23

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. In the 'Kingdom of Fools', both the king and the ministers were complete fools. They didn't want to do things (1)_____ other kingdoms, so they decided to (2)_____ night into day and day into night. They (3)_____ that everyone should be awake at night, (4)_____ their lands and run their (5)_____ only after dark and should go to bed as soon as the sun came up.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(A) ordered
(B) presented
(C) ruled
(D) believed

Q.24

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. In the 'Kingdom of Fools', both the king and the ministers were complete fools. They didn't want to do things (1)_____ other kingdoms, so they decided to (2)_____ night into day and day into night. They (3)_____ that everyone should be awake at night, (4)_____ their lands and run their (5)_____ only after dark and should go to bed as soon as the sun came up.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(A) till
(B) cut
(C) dig
(D) sow

Q.25

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. In the 'Kingdom of Fools', both the king and the ministers were complete fools. They didn't want to do things (1)_____ other kingdoms, so they decided to (2)_____ night into day and day into night. They (3)_____ that everyone should be awake at night, (4)_____ their lands and run their (5)_____ only after dark and should go to bed as soon as the sun came up.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(A) employment
(B) livelihood
(C) career
(D) business

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.2

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

(A) MIGF
(B) BDMS
(C) HKPT
(D) KMPV

Q.3

₹481 is distributed among A, B and C in such a way that B gets two-thirds of what A gets and C gets three-fourths of what B gets. How much does B get?

(A) ₹148
(B) ₹111
(C) ₹168
(D) ₹222

Q.4

Two statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All statements are answers. Some statements are questions. Conclusions: I. No question is a statement. II. Some answers are statements. III. Some questions are statements.

(A) Only conclusions I and III follow
(B) Either conclusion I or III follows
(C) Only conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusions II and III follow

Q.6

If 'A + B' means 'A is the mother of B', 'A × B' means 'A is the sister of B', and 'A * B' means 'A is the daughter of B', then how is R related to P in the following expression? 'R + V × Q × M * P'

(A) Mother
(B) Wife
(C) Daughter
(D) Sister

Q.9

Select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 35, 35, 33, 99, 95, 475, ?

(A) 481
(B) 501
(C) 476
(D) 469

Q.10

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. {2, 2, 9}

(A) {8, 36, 81}
(B) {6, 18, 46}
(C) {4, 8, 25}
(D) {12, 60, 98}

Q.12

In a certain code language, BANKER is coded as 57 and SPAN is coded as 54. How will PRANK be coded in that language?

(A) 58
(B) 61
(C) 65
(D) 69

Q.13

Four numbers have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number that is different.

(A) 2197
(B) 4913
(C) 2379
(D) 1331

Q.14

Select the option in which the numbers in the set share the same relationship as the numbers in the given set. (14, 22, 77)

(A) (20, 16, 105)
(B) (17, 15, 76)
(C) (18, 32, 144)
(D) (22, 11, 86)

Q.15

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of numbers. 28 : 70

(A) 18 : 45
(B) 12 : 32
(C) 30 : 84
(D) 34 : 86

Q.16

'Bracelet' is related to 'Ornaments' in the same way as 'Clove' is related to '_____'.

(A) Spices
(B) Kitchen
(C) Taste
(D) Cooking

Q.19

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in a logical and meaningful order. 1. Class 2. Admission 3. Certificate 4. Application 5. Assessment

(A) 4, 2, 1, 5, 3
(B) 4, 2, 5, 1, 3
(C) 3, 5, 2, 3, 1
(D) 2, 4, 3, 1, 5

Q.20

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 39 ÷ 3 × 13 + 26 – 13 = 2

(A) × and –
(B) ÷ and –
(C) ÷ and ×
(D) + and –

Q.21

Three of the following four words are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) Contentment
(B) Jealousy
(C) Sadness
(D) Disgust

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. NEED : OGHH : : FAST : ?

(A) ECVZ
(B) GCWY
(C) GCVX
(D) GDUX

Q.23

In a code language, SAUCE is written as ASVEC. How will MEANT be written as in that language?

(A) EMANT
(B) MEBTN
(C) EMBTN
(D) EMCTN

Q.24

Select the option that represents the letters that, when placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter sequence correctly. K _ P _ L C _ R _ C P _ N _ P R

(A) E R P R R C
(B) C P P M R R
(C) M R P M R R
(D) C R P M R C

Q.25

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words. Necklace : Gold

(A) Ocean : River
(B) Paper : Wood pulp
(C) Potter : Clay
(D) Grass : Lawn

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Whose autobiography is titled 'The Substance and the Shadow'?

(A) Kishore Kumar
(B) Rajesh Khanna
(C) Raj Kapoor
(D) Dilip Kumar

Q.2
Which of the following file formats does MS Paint use to open and save files in Windows?

(A) .DOC
(B) .XIS
(C) .JPEG
(D) .PPT

Q.3
Which of the following nations ranked first in the World Press Freedom index 2020?

(A) India
(B) France
(C) Norway
(D) The US

Q.4
The musical instrument 'Kartal' from the state of Rajasthan comes under the category of _____.

(A) electrophones
(B) membranophones
(C) chordophones
(D) idiophones

Q.5
Who among the following is India's highest wicket taker in test cricket as of December 2020?

(A) Kapil Dev
(B) Anil Kumble
(C) Narendra Hirwani
(D) Bishan Singh Bedi

Q.6
What is India's rank on the World Economic Forum's Global Competitiveness Index of 141 countries for the year 2019?

(A) 48th
(B) 45th
(C) 68th
(D) 65th

Q.7
The deficiency of which of the following vitamins causes night blindness?

(A) Vitamin B2
(B) Vitamin A
(C) Vitamin E
(D) Vitamin D

Q.8
Which of the following is a computer application software?

(A) Word processor
(B) RAM
(C) Visual Basic
(D) Java

Q.9
How many states does the 'STARS' project launched by the Government of India and World Bank in 2020 seek to cover?

(A) 8
(B) 4
(C) 10
(D) 6

Q.10
In the Battle of Swally (1612) the British fought against the _____.

(A) Danish
(B) Portuguese
(C) French
(D) Dutch

Q.11
Where is Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple) situated?

(A) Amritsar
(B) Patiala
(C) Ludhiana
(D) Jalandhar

Q.12
Which Indian state was the highest contributor to Food Corporation of India (FCI)'s total paddy procurement across the country till May 2020?

(A) Telangana
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Andhra Pradesh
(D) Punjab

Q.13
Heat, in _____, is a type of energy transfer from a warmer substance to a colder one.

(A) gravity
(B) friction
(C) thermodynamics
(D) magnet

Q.14
LAC (Line of Actual Control) is an effective border between India and _____.

(A) Bhutan
(B) Pakistan
(C) Sri Lanka
(D) China

Q.15
In which of the following categories does Indian boxer Lovlina Borgohain play?

(A) 69 kg
(B) 91 kg
(C) 81 kg
(D) 75 kg

Q.16
Dr. Tsering Landol, who was one of the recipients of the Padma Bhushan 2020 award, hails from:

(A) Nagaland
(B) Mizoram
(C) Ladakh
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.17
The National Education Policy (NEP), 2020 commits to raising the total expenditure by states and centre on education to _____ of GDP.

(A) 4%
(B) 6%
(C) 2%
(D) 8%

Q.18
Which sport has been approved to be played at the 2024 Summer Olympics in Paris for the first time?

(A) Parkour race
(B) Darts
(C) Breakdancing
(D) Cricket

Q.19
What was the total number of gold medals won by India at Commonwealth Games 2018?

(A) 44
(B) 33
(C) 26
(D) 18

Q.20
As of January 2021, more than 93% of India's chromite resources were located in:

(A) Odisha
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Karnataka

Q.21
Who among the following presided over the special session of Congress in September 1923 and at the age of 35 became the youngest man to be elected as the President of the Congress?

(A) Mahadev Govind Ranade
(B) Ram Manohar Lohia
(C) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(D) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

Q.22

_____ holds office from the date of his/her election till immediately before the first meeting of the Lok Sabha after the dissolution of the one to which he/she was elected.

(A) Speaker
(B) Minister of Parliamentary Affairs
(C) Minister of Information and Broadcasting
(D) Vice President

Q.23

One-third of the members of the Vidhan Parishad retire every _____ year/s.

(A) four
(B) one
(C) three
(D) two

Q.24

Which among the following is used as the fining agent in wine?

(A) Gelatin
(B) Chlorine
(C) Sodium
(D) Baking Soda

Q.25

'Per Drop More Crop' is the goal for which Government of India scheme?

(A) Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY)
(B) Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana Gramin (PMAY-G)
(C) Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)
(D) Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana (PMMY)

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**
Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) to make something worse

To 'add insult to injury' is to make a bad situation worse.

Q.2 · Answer (D) BADC

B says what Mohan did first, A ('Then') sets him off on the journey, D describes the journey and C gives its hardships: BADC.

Q.3 · Answer (B) without a reasonable explanation

Doing things 'without rhyme or reason' is doing them for no sensible reason that could explain them.

Q.4 · Answer (D) frugal

'Lavish' means extravagant or generous; its opposite is 'frugal', sparing with money. 'Excessive' and 'luxurious' are close to synonyms.

Q.5 · Answer (A) CDAB

C names the first step, D begins it ('Begin by'), A follows with 'Next' and B ends with 'Finally': CDAB.

Q.6 · Answer (D) teems

To 'teem with' is to be full of: that part of the sea is full of sharks.

Q.7 · Answer (A) aversion

'Affinity' is a natural liking or attraction; its opposite is 'aversion', a strong dislike. 'Inclination' and 'attraction' are close to synonyms.

Q.8 · Answer (C) arrivel

The correct spelling is 'arrival'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) furious

'Livid' means very angry: 'furious'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) The car was driven very carefully on the hilly terrain.

The simple past active 'drove' becomes the simple past passive 'was driven', with the car as subject.

Q.11 · Answer (B) as well as also money

'As well as' already means 'and also', so 'also' is redundant: 'it will save you time as well as money'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) during the day

Something done in the daytime is done 'during the day', in contrast with 'at night'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Deepu told Reena that he loved Bollywood music.

'Said to' becomes 'told', 'I' becomes 'he' and the present 'love' moves back to the past 'loved'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) matricide

Matricide is the killing of one's mother; patricide is the killing of one's father, infanticide of an infant and regicide of a king.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Notwithstanding we were

Being busy is the reason the outing was cancelled, so the clause needs 'As' or 'Since': 'As we were all busy that weekend, we had to cancel the outing.' 'Notwithstanding' means 'in spite of'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) titilate

The correct spelling is 'titillate'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) insensitive

'Callous' means showing no concern for others' feelings: 'insensitive'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) fortnight

A fortnight is a period of two weeks.

Q.19 · Answer (B) No improvement
'One of' is followed by a plural noun, and 'one of my gloves' says that a single glove was dropped, so no change is needed.

Q.20 · Answer (B) heartening
'Heartening' means encouraging or cheering: the sight of people helping lifts the spirits. 'Savouring' and 'relishing' mean enjoying something, which does not fit 'It is ___ to see'.

Q.21 · Answer (A) like
They did not want to do things 'like' other kingdoms, that is, in the same way as them.

Q.22 · Answer (C) change
They decided to 'change' night into day: the phrase is 'change into'.

Q.23 · Answer (A) ordered
The king and his ministers 'ordered' that everyone should be awake at night.

Q.24 · Answer (A) till
To 'till' the land is to plough and prepare it for crops.

Q.25 · Answer (D) business
People were to 'run their business', their trade and work, only after dark.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (A) MIGF
In BDMS, HKPT and KMPV each letter comes later in the alphabet than the one before it. MIGF runs backwards, so it is the odd one.

Q.3 · Answer (A) ₹148
B = (2/3)A and C = (3/4)B = (1/2)A, so A : B : C = 6 : 4 : 3. 481 ÷ 13 = 37, so B gets 4 × 37 = ₹148.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Only conclusions II and III follow
All statements are answers, so some answers are statements (II). Some statements are questions, so some questions are statements (III), which rules out I.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Wife
R is the mother of V; V, Q and M are sisters; and M is the daughter of P. So R and P are M's parents: R is P's wife.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 469
Multiply by 1, subtract 2, multiply by 3, subtract 4, multiply by 5, subtract 6: 35, 35, 33, 99, 95, 475, so next comes 475 − 6 = 469.

Q.10 · Answer (C) {4, 8, 25}
In {2, 2, 9} the second number is half the square of the first ($2^2 \div 2 = 2$) and the third is the square of one more than the first ($3^2 = 9$). Likewise $4^2 \div 2 = 8$ and $5^2 = 25$.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 65
Each code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet plus the number of letters: BANKER = 2 + 1 + 14 + 11 + 5 + 18 + 6 = 57 and SPAN = 19 + 16 + 1 + 14 + 4 = 54. So PRANK = 16 + 18 + 1 + 14 + 11 + 5 = 65.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 2379
$2197 = 13^3$, $4913 = 17^3$ and $1331 = 11^3$; 2379 is not a perfect cube, so it is the odd one.

Q.14 · Answer (C) (18, 32, 144)
The third number is the product of the first two divided by 4: 14 × 22 ÷ 4 = 77. Likewise 18 × 32 ÷ 4 = 144.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 18 : 45
The second number is 2.5 times the first: 28 × 2.5 = 70. Likewise 18 × 2.5 = 45.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Spices
A bracelet is a kind of ornament, as a clove is a kind of spice.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 4, 2, 1, 5, 3
Application (4), Admission (2), Class (1), Assessment (5), Certificate (3).

Q.20 · Answer (B) ÷ and –
Interchanging ÷ and –: 39 – 3 × 13 + 26 ÷ 13 = 39 – 39 + 2 = 2.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Contentment
Contentment is a pleasant feeling; jealousy, sadness and disgust are unpleasant ones.

Q.22 · Answer (C) GCVX
N, E, E, D move +1, +2, +3, +4 to give OGHH. Likewise F, A, S, T give G, C, V, X: GCVX.

Q.23 · Answer (C) EMBTN
The first two letters swap, the middle one moves one place forward and the last two swap: SA U CE → AS V EC. So ME A NT → EM B TN: EMBTN.

Q.24 · Answer (D) C R P M R C
With C, R, P, M, R, C in the blanks the series reads KCPR LCPR MCPR NCPR: the first letter moves one place forward each time and CPR repeats.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Paper : Wood pulp
A necklace is made from gold, as paper is made from wood pulp.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Dilip Kumar
'The Substance and the Shadow' (2014) is the autobiography of the actor Dilip Kumar.

Q.2 · Answer (C) .JPEG
MS Paint opens and saves image files such as JPEG, PNG, BMP and GIF; .DOC, .XLS and .PPT are Word, Excel and PowerPoint formats.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Norway
Norway topped Reporters Without Borders' World Press Freedom Index 2020, for the fourth year running.

Q.4 · Answer (D) idiophones
The kartal is a pair of wooden clappers struck together; an instrument whose own body vibrates to make the sound is an idiophone.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Anil Kumble
Anil Kumble took 619 Test wickets, the most by an Indian bowler.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 68th
India fell ten places, from 58th to 68th of 141 economies, in the World Economic Forum's Global Competitiveness Index 2019.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Vitamin A
Vitamin A is needed to make rhodopsin, the light-sensitive pigment of the retina, so its deficiency causes night blindness.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Word processor
A word processor is application software for writing documents. RAM is hardware, and Visual Basic and Java are programming languages.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 6
STARS (Strengthening Teaching-Learning and Results for States), backed by the World Bank, covers six states: Himachal Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Kerala and Odisha.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Portuguese
At Swally (Suvali), near Surat, the English East India Company's ships under Thomas Best defeated the Portuguese in 1612.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Amritsar
The Harmandir Sahib, the holiest gurdwara of Sikhism, is in Amritsar, Punjab.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Telangana
SSC's key gives Telangana, which supplied the largest share of the paddy procured in the 2019-20 rabi (yasangi) season, the procurement under way in April and May 2020. Over the whole 2019-20 marketing season, kharif included, Punjab procured more.

Q.13 · Answer (C) thermodynamics
In thermodynamics, heat is energy that passes from a hotter body to a colder one because of the difference in their temperatures.

Q.14 · Answer (D) China
The Line of Actual Control separates Indian-held and Chinese-held territory; the line with Pakistan in Jammu and Kashmir is the Line of Control.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 69 kg
SSC's key gives 69 kg: when the exam was held, in August 2021, Lovlina Borgohain boxed as a welterweight (69 kg), in which she had just won bronze at the Tokyo Olympics. She later moved up to 75 kg, the class in which she won the 2023 world title.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Ladakh
Dr Tsering Landol, Ladakh's first woman gynaecologist, received the Padma Bhushan in 2020 for her work in women's healthcare.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 6%
NEP 2020 aims to raise public spending on education by the Centre and the states together to 6% of GDP.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Breakdancing
In December 2020 the IOC added breaking (breakdancing) to the Paris 2024 programme, its first appearance at the Olympic Games.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 26
India won 66 medals at the 2018 Commonwealth Games on the Gold Coast: 26 gold, 20 silver and 20 bronze.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Odisha
Odisha holds well over 90% of India's chromite resources, most of them in the Sukinda valley.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
Maulana Abul Kalam Azad presided over the special session at Delhi in September 1923; at 35 he was the youngest President of the Congress.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Speaker
Under Article 94 the Speaker does not vacate office when the Lok Sabha is dissolved, but holds it until just before the new House first meets.

Q.23 · Answer (D) two
A Legislative Council is not dissolved; as nearly as possible one-third of its members retire on the expiry of every second year (Article 172(2)).

Q.24 · Answer (A) Gelatin
Gelatin is added to wine as a fining agent: it binds tannins and haze-forming particles so that they settle out.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY)
'Per Drop More Crop', which promotes micro-irrigation such as drip and sprinklers, is a component of the Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana.

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